

أدوات التعريف والتذكير في الأخبار الاقتصادية الإنجليزية: دراسة قائمة على المتون اللغوية لأنماط الإحالة الدلالية

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الملخص

تبحث هذه الدراسة في ظهور واستخدام أدوات التعريف (the) وأدوات التذكير (a/an)، مع تحديد أنواع الإشارة الدلالية الخاصة بها (Reference Types) في الأخبار الاقتصادية باللغة الإنجليزية. وتستند الدراسة إلى قلة الأبحاث اللغوية والدراسات السابقة في هذا المجال، ولا سيما في سياق الأخبار الاقتصادية باللغة الإنجليزية.

تكشف الدراسة، بالاعتماد على أدلة أبحاث الكوربس، عن كيفية ظهور هذه الأدوات، سواء المعرفة أو غير المعرفة، في مجال الصحافة المهنية وصياغة الأخبار الاقتصادية، وعن كيفية توظيف أنواع الإشارة الدلالية الخاصة بها في تنظيم المعنى المحدد، والخاص، والعام.

اعتمدت هذه الدراسة على منهج مختلط، يجمع بين التحليل الكمي والنوعي، لدراسة ظهور وتكرار أدوات التعريف والتذكير في كوربس يتكوّن من مليون كلمة و1,174,893 توكن. وقد جُمعت الأخبار بين 1 يناير و31 مارس 2026 من عشرة مصادر متخصصة في الأخبار الاقتصادية.

تجيب هذه الدراسة عن سؤالين بحثيين رئيسيين: ما الأدوات الأكثر تكرارًا من بين أدوات التعريف والتذكير؟ وما أنواع الإشارة الدلالية الأكثر استخدامًا في هذه الأدوات؟ وباستخدام برنامج Sketch Engine، تم تطبيق منهج الترميز الدلالي (Semantic Coding) على 2000 عينة، شملت 1,402 إشارة خاصة، و598 إشارة غير خاصة، و19 إشارة عامة، و1,981 إشارة دلالية غير عامة (Non-generic) وتشير هذه النتائج إلى أن الأخبار الاقتصادية باللغة الإنجليزية تعتمد بدرجة كبيرة على الإشارة الخاصة (Specific Reference) في سياق الخطاب الاقتصادي.

وبشكل عام، تُظهر النتائج أن اختيار الأداة في الصحافة الاقتصادية يساعد في عرض المؤسسات، وتبسيط الضوء على الأحداث، وتقديم المؤشرات والمعايير الاقتصادية بوصفها عناصر معروفة، وخاصة، ومستقرة داخل سياق الأخبار الاقتصادية.

الكلمات المفتاحية: أدوات التعريف والتأكيد الإنجليزية، الإشارة الدلالية، الأخبار الاقتصادية، لغويات الكوربس.

ئامرازه كانى ناسراو و نه ناسراو له هه والى ئابوورى ئىنگليزىدا: توثيرنه وه يه كى
كوڤه س-بنه ما يه له سهر جوڤره كانى ئامازهى مانايى (واتايى)

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پوخته

ئەم توپىزىنە ۋە ئەنجام دراۋە لەسەر پروودان و دەرکەوتنى ئامرازى ناسراو the و نەناسراو a/an، لەگەل دەستىشاندەردى جۆرى ئامازە واتايە كانيان (Reference types) لە ھەوالى ئابوورى ئىنگىلىزىدا. توپىزىنە ۋە كە بنىاد نراۋە لەسەر نەبۇنى لىكۆلىنە ۋە زىمانە ۋانى و ھىچ توپىزىنە ۋە كە لەم بوارەدا، بەتايىت لە ھەوالى ئابورى بە زىمانى ئىنگىلىزىدا. لىكۆلىنە ۋە كە بە پىشت بەستىن بە بەلگە توپىزىنە ۋە كۆرىپەس، دەرەدە خات چۆن ئەم ئامرازانە (ناسراو ۋە نەناسراو) لەبوارى پىشەى رۆژنامە نووسىيى و سازدانى ھەوالى ئابورى دا دەرەدە كەون و كەلەك لەجۆرى ئامازەى واتايان دەبىنرەت بۆ رىكخستى واتاي ديارىكراو، تايەتمەندى، و گىشتى. ئەم توپىزىنە ۋە كە پىشتى بەستە بەرپىزى تىكەل (چەندايەتى و چۆنايەتى) دەرەكەوتن و فرىكوپىسى ئامرازەكانى ناسراو و نەناسراو لەناو كۆرىپەسىك كە لەيەك مىيۇن ووشەو، 1,174,893 و تۆكى لى لەخۆگرتوۋە. لە ئىۋان 1ى كانوونى دوۋەم تا 31ى ئادارى 2026 لە دە سەرچاۋە ھەوالى ئابوورى. ھەوالەكان كۆكرانەتە ۋە ئەم لىكۆلىنە ۋە كە ۋەلامى دوۋىرسىارى توپىزىنە ۋە كە دەتە ۋە كە زۆرتىن ئامرازەكانى دوۋارەبە ۋە لە ناسراو و نەناسراۋە كامانەن ۋە زۆرتىن جۆرى ئامازەى واتايان بەكام جۆرى ئارتىكلە دەستىشاندە كرىت. بە بەكارھىنانى سۆفتۋىرى سىكچ ئىنجىن رىپازى Semantic Coding كۆد كەردى واتايى دەرەكەوت لە ۲۰۰۰ نەمۇنە 1,402 ئامازەى تايەت، 598 ئامازەى ناتايەت، 19 ئامازەى گىشتى، و 1,981 ئامازەى واتاي **تايەتى** ناگىشتى (Non-generic) پىككەھىن؛ ئەمەش نىشان دەدات كە ھەوالى ئابوورى ئىنگىلىزى بە شىۋەيەكى بەھىز و زىاتر پىشت بە واتاي ئامازەى تايەت (specific reference) (بۆ بارودۆخى ھەوالى ئابورى دەبەستىت. بە گىشتى، ئەنجامەكان دەرەدە خەن كە ھەلپزاردى ئامراز لە رۆژنامە نووسىيى ئابوورىدا يارمەتى دەرە بۆ پىشاندانى و ناساندنى دامەزراۋەكان، ديارخستى پرووداۋەكان، و پىۋەرە ئابوورىيەكان ۋەك شتگەلىكى ناسراو، تايەت، و جىگىركراۋ لە چوارچىۋە ھەوالى ئابورى بەتەۋاۋى رەنگى داۋەتە ۋە.

ۋشە سەرەكىيەكان: ئامرازەكانى ناسراو و نەناسراۋى ئىنگىلىزى، ئامازەى واتايى، ھەوالى ئابوورى، زىمانە ۋانى كۆرىپەس

Definite and Indefinite Articles in English Economic News: A Corpus-Based Study of Semantic Reference Types

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Abstract

This study examines the occurrence of the definite article *the* and the indefinite articles *a/an*, and the semantic reference categories they mark in contemporary English economic news. It addresses the limited corpus-based evidence on how professional economic journalism uses overt articles to organize definiteness, specificity, and genericity across outlets. Using a mixed-methods corpus-based design, the study combines quantitative frequency analysis with qualitative semantic reference coding. The data come from the English Economic News Corpus 2026 (EENC-2026), a balanced, specialized, manually compiled, synchronic one-million-word corpus collected from ten English-language economic news outlets between January 1 and March 31, 2026; after Sketch Engine processing, it contained 1,174,893 tokens. Frequencies were extracted for *the*, *a*, *an*, and total *a/an*. Semantic analysis was based on 2,000 randomly sampled noun phrases, with 100 definite and 100 indefinite samples from each outlet. The coded data were organized in Microsoft Excel and analyzed using IBM SPSS Statistics, Version 27, through cross-tabulations, chi-square tests, and inter-coder reliability on a 200-sample subset. The findings show that *the* occurs 61,311 times, while *a/an* occurs 25,368 times, representing 70.73% and 29.27% of overt article tokens, respectively. Semantic coding identifies 1,402 specific, 598 non-specific, 19 generic, and 1,981 non-generic references, showing that English economic news strongly favors specific and context-bound reference. Overall, the findings indicate that article choice in economic journalism helps present economic entities, events, and indicators as identifiable, specific, and situated in immediate news contexts.

Keywords: English Articles , Semantic Reference, Economic News, Corpus Linguistics

1. Introduction

English articles are compact grammatical markers with important discourse-semantic roles. The definite article *the* generally presents a referent as identifiable, unique, recoverable from context, or shared knowledge, whereas *a/an* usually introduces a referent as non-unique or newly introduced. However,

article interpretation also depends on specificity and genericity, not only on article form ([Hawkins, 1978](#); [Huddleston & Pullum, 2002](#); [Lyons, 1999](#)). These meanings are especially important in news discourse, where writers condense information and rely on shared institutional knowledge ([Bednarek & Caple, 2012](#); [Bell, 1991](#)).

Economic news intensifies this need because it repeatedly names markets, central banks, prices, indicators, policies, and reports, often through dense noun phrases. This register is therefore suitable for examining how article choice helps organize identifiable, specific, and context-bound reference ([Akbarova, 2024](#); [Li & Gao, 2023](#)). The present study examines definite and indefinite articles in EENC-2026, a balanced one-million-word corpus manually compiled from ten English-language economic news outlets. It asks whether *the* is more frequent than *a/an*, how article-marked noun phrases express definiteness, specificity, and genericity, and how frequencies vary across outlets.

The study is significant because it combines corpus-frequency evidence with semantic coding and inter-coder reliability. It therefore treats articles not as minor function words, but as reference-management devices that help economic journalists present entities, institutions, and events as identifiable, specific, and situated in immediate news contexts.

2. Literature Review

The English article system is traditionally described through the contrast between definiteness and indefiniteness. The definite article *the* signals that a referent is identifiable to the reader, whereas *a/an* usually introduces one member of a class or a referent that is not yet uniquely identifiable. Standard grammars treat this contrast as central to English noun-phrase interpretation ([Biber et al., 1999](#); [Huddleston & Pullum, 2002](#); [Quirk et al., 1985](#)). However, article meaning cannot be explained by form alone. A noun phrase with *the* may be definite because of uniqueness, shared knowledge, or situational context, while an indefinite noun phrase may still be specific when the writer has a particular referent in mind.

Theoretical studies of definiteness emphasize accessibility and identifiability. A reference is definite when the reader can identify the intended referent through previous discourse, contextual knowledge, uniqueness, or shared assumptions ([Gundel et al., 1993](#); [Hawkins, 1978](#); [Lyons, 1999](#)). This is highly relevant to economic news because journalists often refer to *the government*, *the economy*, *the central bank*, or *the market* without lengthy introduction. The reader is expected to retrieve the referent from the economic context and from shared institutional knowledge.

Specificity adds another layer to article interpretation. Definiteness concerns whether the reader can identify a referent, whereas specificity concerns whether the writer has a particular referent in mind. Indefinite noun phrases may therefore be referential or non-specific, depending on context ([Fodor & Sag, 1982](#); [Heim, 1982](#); [von Heusinger, 2002](#)). For example, *a new report* may be indefinite but specific if it refers to a particular document, while *a better recovery* may be non-specific if it refers to a possible future condition. This distinction is central to the present coding framework.

Genericity concerns whether a noun phrase refers to a class, kind, domain, or general concept rather than a particular instance. Generic reference is a major semantic category in English noun-phrase interpretation ([Carlson, 1977](#); [Carlson & Pelletier, 1995](#); [Krifka et al., 1995](#)). In economic reporting, a term such as *market* may refer to a specific market reaction in one context and to a broad economic domain in another. Genericity therefore cannot be inferred automatically from article form; it must be coded from context.

News discourse is characterized by compact information packaging, institutional reference, and a high density of noun phrases ([Bednarek & Caple, 2012](#); [Bell, 1991](#); [Fairclough, 1995](#)). Economic news strengthens these features because it regularly reports indicators, prices, policies, central-bank actions, business outcomes, and market movements. Register studies also show that grammatical patterns vary according to communicative purpose ([Biber, 2006](#); [Biber & Conrad, 2009](#); [Biber & Conrad, 2019](#)). Economic news can therefore be treated as a specialized register in which article choice supports rapid identification of economic entities and events.

Corpus linguistics provides the methodological foundation for this study. Frequency lists, concordance lines, and subcorpus comparisons allow grammatical patterns to be studied empirically rather than impressionistically ([Biber et al., 2021](#); [Hunston, 2022](#); [McEnery & Hardie, 2012](#); [Sinclair, 1991](#)). Sketch Engine is particularly useful because it supports frequency searches, concordance display, CQL queries, and random sampling, while AntConc provides an additional platform for checking corpus patterns ([Anthony, 2020](#); [Kilgariff et al., 2014](#)).

2.1 Previous Studies

Previous research has examined article use, news discourse, economic language, corpus-based grammar, and semantic reference from different perspectives. These studies provide an important background for the present research, although none combines article-frequency analysis with semantic

coding of definiteness, specificity, and genericity in a balanced corpus of contemporary English economic news.

Delice and Pinto (2025) investigated the relationship between financial-news language and economic analysis. Their study used textual data and news-content analysis to examine how information from news can support economic interpretation. The study is relevant because it shows that economic-news language is not simply descriptive; it can contribute to how economic conditions are understood. However, its focus is mainly lexical, textual, and analytical rather than grammatical. It does not examine article marking or how noun phrases are organized semantically.

Valdeón (2025) reviewed twenty-five years of journalistic translation research and discussed how global news production is shaped by methods, topics, and stylistic pressures. This is useful for the present study because news writers frequently make compact grammatical choices to present information quickly. However, Valdeón's work is mainly concerned with journalistic translation and global news research. It does not provide a quantitative account of definite and indefinite article frequencies, nor does it code article-marked noun phrases for reference categories.

Lei (2025) conducted a corpus-based critical discourse analysis of post-pandemic news reports. Using frequency lists and corpus tools, the study identified dominant lexical patterns and themes in news discourse. The findings show how corpus methods can reveal repeated patterns in large news datasets. This is methodologically relevant to the present research because it supports the use of corpus tools for studying news language. Nevertheless, Lei's study focuses on content words and discourse themes rather than grammatical reference. It identifies common topics in news, but not how article-marked noun phrases structure reference.

Salih et al. (2024) examined noun post-modifiers in political news through a corpus-based quantitative approach. Their study found that post-modifying structures, especially prepositional phrases, are common in news noun phrases. This is relevant because it confirms that noun-phrase structure is a key feature of news discourse. However, their analysis focuses on elements that follow the noun, while the present study focuses on articles, which occur before the noun and help determine the reference value of the noun phrase. The current study therefore extends noun-phrase research by examining the determiner position rather than post-modification alone.

Derkach and Alexopoulou (2024) studied definite and indefinite article accuracy in learner English. Their work is particularly important because it highlights the role of specificity in article choice. They show that article use

cannot be explained only through definiteness; specificity also affects whether a speaker or writer has a particular referent in mind. This supports the coding framework of the present study, which separates definiteness from specificity. However, their study is based on learner English and article accuracy, while the present research analyzes professional journalistic language. In economic news, article choices are treated as discourse strategies, not learner errors.

Akbarova (2024) examined the discourse characteristics of economic texts, emphasizing the density and nominal nature of economic language. The study shows that economic discourse frequently uses nominalization and abstract nouns such as *growth*, *inflation*, *decline*, and *recovery*. This is directly relevant because articles often precede such nouns and influence whether they are presented as identifiable, specific, abstract, or context-bound. However, Akbarova's study does not focus specifically on the article system. It explains the nominal nature of economic discourse, but does not examine how definite and indefinite articles contribute to reference.

Clancy and Vaughan (2023) demonstrate the value of corpus linguistic methods in the analysis of economic news texts. Their work shows how concordance lines, keywords, and repeated patterns can reveal meanings that are difficult to identify through manual reading alone. This supports the use of Sketch Engine and corpus-based analysis in the present study. However, their emphasis is broader discourse interpretation rather than the semantic classification of article-marked noun phrases. The present study builds on this methodological direction by combining corpus extraction with semantic reference coding.

Li and Gao (2023) examined semantic and sentimental features of economic news texts. Their study shows that economic news may vary in its use of concrete and abstract meanings. This distinction is relevant because specificity and genericity depend partly on whether a noun phrase refers to a concrete event, institution, indicator, or a more general economic concept. However, Li and Gao do not directly examine article forms. Their study helps explain the semantic environment of economic news, while the present study examines how articles signal reference within that environment.

Park (2023) analyzed English article occurrence patterns with attention to genericity. Because genericity is one of the central semantic categories in article interpretation, the study is useful for the present research. Park's findings support the view that article use is related to whether a noun phrase refers to a class, kind, or broad concept. However, Park's research does not focus on contemporary professional economic news from multiple outlets. The present study therefore applies genericity coding to a specialized economic-news corpus

and compares generic and non-generic reference across definite and indefinite article samples.

Poesio and Vieira (1998) provided one of the most relevant earlier studies by investigating definite descriptions in Wall Street Journal data. Their study showed that definite descriptions do not always refer back to previously mentioned information; they may introduce new referents when readers can identify them through shared knowledge or bridging inference. This is highly relevant to economic news, where expressions such as *the economy*, *the market*, and *the Federal Reserve* may be treated as identifiable even without prior mention. However, their study focused mainly on definite descriptions and earlier Wall Street Journal data. The present study extends this line of research by analyzing both definite and indefinite articles across ten contemporary economic news outlets.

Taken together, these studies show that previous research has examined sentiment and news analytics, news style, corpus-based discourse patterns, noun-phrase structure, learner article use, economic discourse, and definite descriptions ([Akbarova, 2024](#); [Clancy & Vaughan, 2023](#); [Delice & Pinto, 2025](#); [Derkach & Alexopoulou, 2024](#); [Lei, 2025](#); [Li & Gao, 2023](#); [Park, 2023](#); [Poesio & Vieira, 1998](#); [Salih et al., 2024](#); [Valdeón, 2025](#)). However, there remains a clear gap in research on how definite and indefinite articles mark semantic reference categories in contemporary English economic news. The present study addresses this gap by combining quantitative frequency analysis with semantic coding of definiteness, specificity, and genericity in a balanced, specialized, synchronic corpus of ten major economic news outlets.

3. Methodology

3.1 Research Design and Corpus Description

The study uses a mixed-methods corpus-based design that combines quantitative frequency analysis with qualitative semantic reference coding. The quantitative component counts the frequency of *the*, *a*, *an*, and combined *a/an* in the full corpus and in each outlet subcorpus. The qualitative component codes 2,000 randomly selected article-marked noun phrases for definiteness, specificity, and genericity. This design is suitable because article use is both frequent and meaning-sensitive: counting reveals distributional patterns, while semantic coding clarifies the reference values expressed in context.

The English Economic News Corpus 2026 (EENC-2026) is a manually compiled, balanced, specialized, monolingual, synchronic corpus of written English economic news. By design, it contains 1,000,000 running words, with

100,000 words collected from each of ten outlets. After processing in Sketch Engine, the corpus contained 1,174,893 tokens. The difference between the word total and token total reflects automatic tokenization, which counts punctuation, contractions, digits, and other textual units differently from manual word counting.

Table 1: Corpus Composition by Outlet

Outlet	Sketch Engine tokens
AP	117,779
BBC	117,478
CNN	118,407
Reuters	118,858
The Guardian	117,662
Bloomberg	116,116
CNBC	119,102
The Wall Street Journal	116,598
The New York Times	115,795
The Telegraph	117,098

Note. Each outlet contributed 100,000 words during manual corpus construction; token counts reflect Sketch Engine tokenization after processing.

3.2 Corpus Balancing and Outlet-Based Word Control

Corpus balancing was controlled at the word level. Each of the ten outlet subcorpora contributed 100,000 running words, preventing larger outlets from dominating the frequency results. After Sketch Engine processing, tokenization produced slightly different token totals across outlets. For this reason, the analysis reports both raw frequencies and normalized per-million-token frequencies. Raw frequencies show the absolute number of article occurrences, while normalized frequencies standardize those counts in relation to corpus size, allowing fairer comparison across outlets.

3.3 Outlet Selection, Time Period, and Collection

The ten outlets were selected after preliminary checking with Sketch Engine and BootCaT Corpus Builder, followed by manual screening. These tools helped identify and confirm English-language news sources that regularly published

economic news suitable for the study ([Baroni & Bernardini, 2004](#); [Kilgarriff et al., 2014](#)). The selected outlets were Associated Press, BBC, Bloomberg, CNBC, CNN, The New York Times, Reuters, The Guardian, The Telegraph, and The Wall Street Journal. Articles were then collected manually between January 1 and March 31, 2026. Non-economic texts, duplicates, inaccessible items, and unsuitable materials were excluded during corpus preparation.

3.4 Frequency Analysis and Sampling Procedure

Article frequencies were extracted for *the*, *a*, and *an*. The forms *a* and *an* were also combined as total *a/an*. Raw frequency refers to the actual number of occurrences found in the corpus or outlet subcorpus. Normalized frequency refers to the rate per million tokens, calculated as raw frequency divided by the relevant token total and multiplied by 1,000,000. This standardization allows outlets with slightly different Sketch Engine token totals to be compared fairly. For semantic coding, Sketch Engine concordance results were used to select 2,000 random noun phrases: 100 definite article samples and 100 indefinite article samples from each outlet.

3.5 Semantic Coding, Reliability, and Statistics

Each noun phrase was coded along three semantic dimensions: definiteness, specificity, and genericity. Generic reference means that the noun phrase refers to a class, kind, domain, or general concept, while non-generic reference refers to a particular entity, event, dataset, or context-bound situation. Specific reference refers to a particular identifiable entity, event, institution, indicator, or amount, while non-specific reference is hypothetical, predictive, evaluative, abstract, general, or not a concrete instance. Definite reference is identifiable, unique, previously mentioned, or contextually known, while non-definite reference is introduced or not uniquely identifiable in context.

Table 2: Semantic Reference Coding Framework

Code	Dimension	Reference name	Definition
1	Genericity	Generic reference	Class, kind, domain, or general concept
2	Genericity	Non-generic reference	Particular situation, event, entity, dataset, or context-bound referent
3	Specificity	Specific reference	Particular identifiable entity, event,

Code	Dimension	Reference name	Definition
			institution, indicator, or amount
4	Specificity	Non-specific reference	Hypothetical, predictive, abstract, evaluative, general, or not a concrete instance
5	Definiteness	Definite reference	Identifiable, unique, previously mentioned, or contextually known
6	Definiteness	Non-definite reference	Introduced, open, nonspecific, or not uniquely identifiable in context

Inter-coder reliability was checked on 200 samples using the same semantic framework. The final reliability dataset contained no missing or invalid coding cells. After semantic coding, the coded data were organized, checked, and tabulated in Microsoft Excel. Cross-tabulations, chi-square tests, Cramer's V, pairwise similarity, and inter-coder reliability statistics were then calculated using IBM SPSS Statistics, Version 27 ([IBM Corp., 2020](#)). Excel was used for data cleaning, coding-sheet arrangement, and summary tables, while SPSS was used for statistical testing and reliability analysis.

4. Results

4.1 Overall Article Frequencies

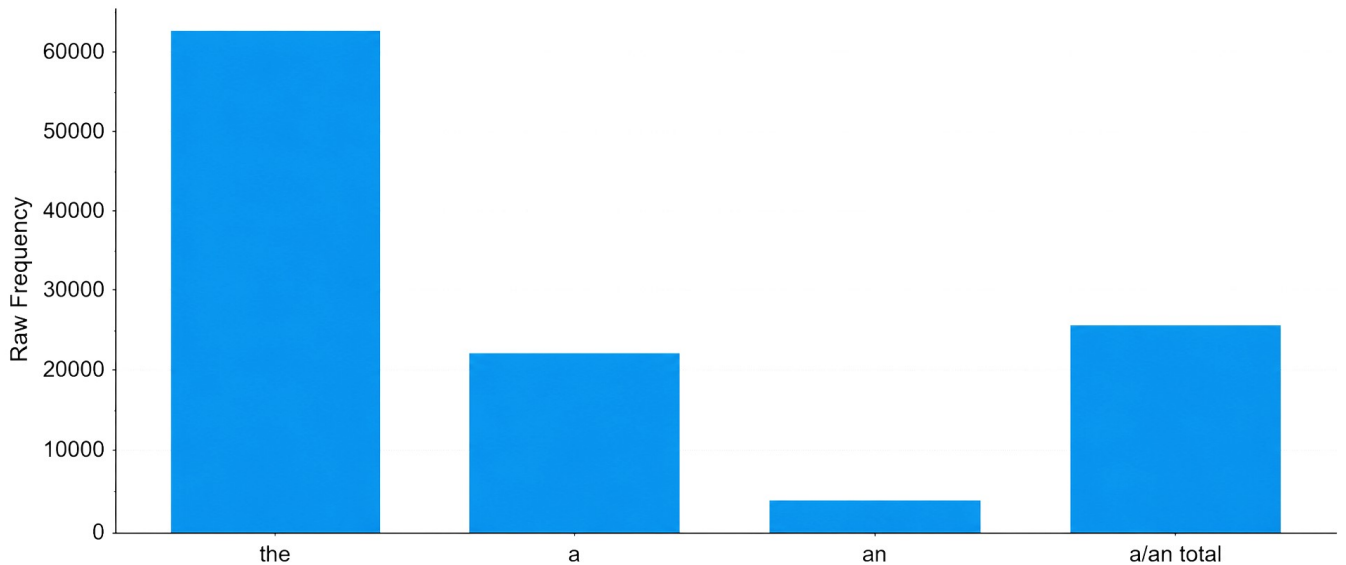
The overall frequency results show that the definite article is dominant in English economic news. In EENC-2026, *the* occurs 61,311 times, while *a* occurs 21,914 times and *an* occurs 3,454 times. There are 25,368 instances of the indefinite articles *a/an*. Out of the 86,679 overt article tokens examined, *the* accounts for 70.73%, whereas *a/an* accounts for 29.27%. This dominance is consistent with the institutional and event-based nature of economic reporting, where readers are often expected to recognize markets, known institutions, economic indicators, and previously established events from shared context.

Table 3: Overall Article Frequencies in EENC-2026

Article form/category	Raw frequency	Per million tokens	Share of analyzed overt articles
<i>the</i>	61,311	52,184.33	70.73%
<i>a</i>	21,914	18,651.91	25.28%

Article form/category	Raw frequency	Per million tokens	Share of analyzed overt articles
<i>an</i>	3,454	2,939.84	3.98%
<i>a/an</i> total	25,368	21,591.75	29.27%

Figure 1: Overall Frequencies of the Definite Article and Indefinite Article Forms in EENC-2026



Note. The figure shows raw frequencies, meaning the actual number of article hits before adjustment for corpus size. It presents the absolute occurrence of *the*, *a*, *an*, and the combined *a/an* category in EENC-2026. The much higher bar for *the* shows the overall dominance of definite article marking in the corpus.

4.2 Outlet-Based Frequency Patterns

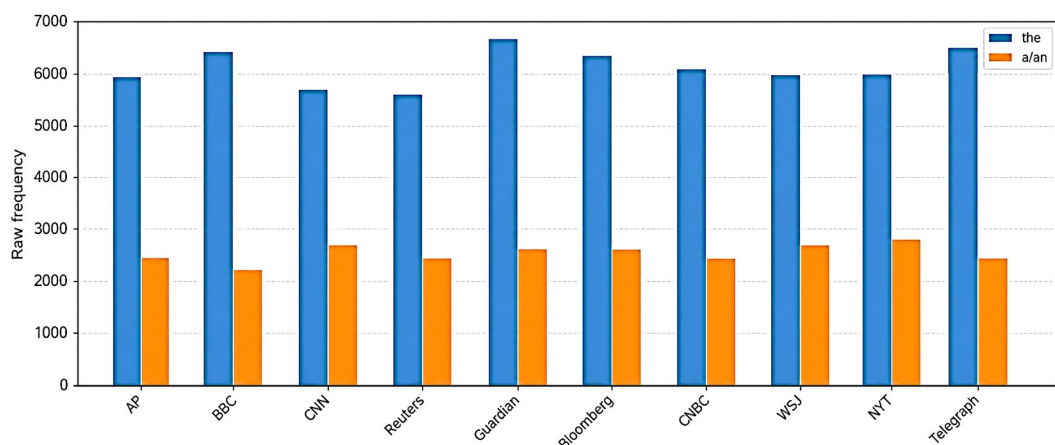
Outlet comparison shows that the definite article is more frequent than the total indefinite category in every outlet. Raw frequencies describe the absolute number of article hits in each outlet, while normalized frequencies describe the rate per million tokens. The Guardian records the highest raw frequency of *the*, followed by The Telegraph, BBC, and Bloomberg. The New York Times records the highest total *a/an* frequency. The normalized results confirm that the dominance of *the* is not simply a result of small differences in outlet token totals.

Table 4: Article Frequencies Across Outlets

Outlet	Tokens	<i>the</i>	<i>a</i>	<i>an</i>	<i>a/an</i>	the per million	<i>a/an</i> per million	the share
AP	117,779	5,926	2,129	310	2,439	50,314.57	20,708.28	70.84%
BBC	117,478	6,408	1,880	336	2,216	54,546.38	18,863.11	74.30%

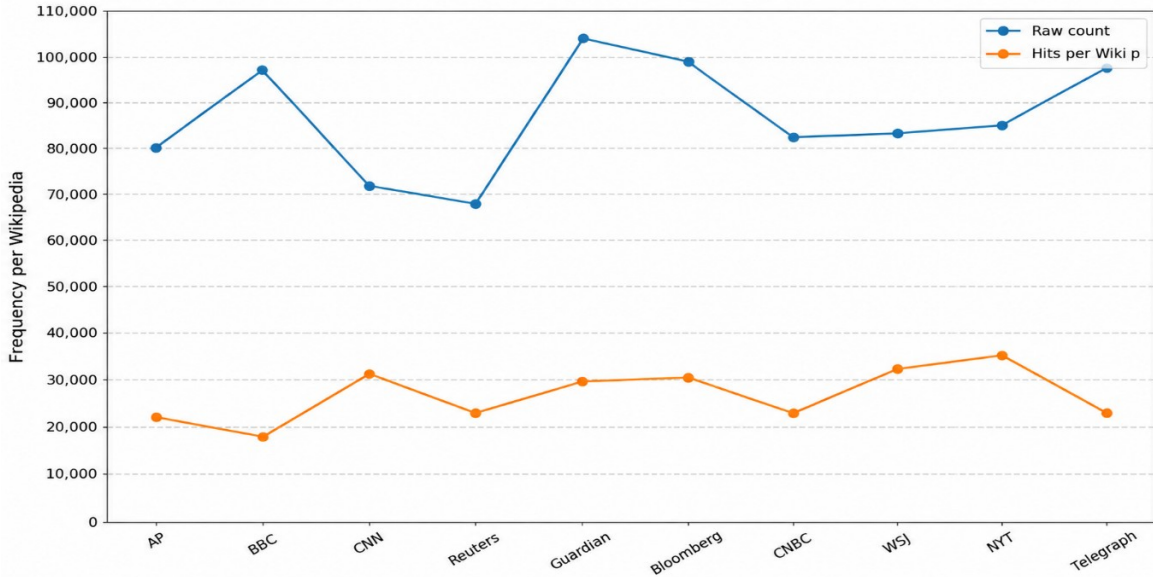
Outlet	Tokens	<i>the</i>	<i>a</i>	<i>an</i>	<i>a/an</i>	the per million	<i>a/an</i> per million	the share
CNN	118,407	5,716	2,351	356	2,707	48,274.17	22,861.82	67.86%
Reuters	118,858	5,624	2,135	312	2,447	47,316.97	20,587.59	69.68%
The Guardian	117,662	6,680	2,272	346	2,618	56,772.79	22,250.17	71.84%
Bloomberg	116,116	6,366	2,262	348	2,610	54,824.49	22,477.52	70.92%
CNBC	119,102	6,100	2,117	325	2,442	51,216.60	20,503.43	71.41%
The Wall Street Journal	116,598	5,991	2,290	391	2,681	51,381.67	22,993.53	69.08%
The New York Times	115,795	6,018	2,405	377	2,782	51,971.16	24,025.22	68.39%
The Telegraph	117,098	6,482	2,073	353	2,426	55,355.34	20,717.69	72.77%

Figure 2: Raw Frequencies of the Definite Article and Total Indefinite Articles by Outlet



Note. The figure shows raw article frequencies by outlet. Raw frequency means the actual number of hits found within each outlet subcorpus. Because the outlets have slightly different Sketch Engine token totals, these values show absolute volume; Figure 3 provides the standardized rate-based comparison.

Figure 3: Normalized Frequencies per Million Tokens by Outlet



Note. The figure shows normalized article frequencies per million tokens. Normalized frequency is calculated by dividing raw hits by the outlet token total and multiplying by 1,000,000. This standardization allows fair comparison across outlets with slightly different token totals and confirms that *the* remains more frequent after size adjustment.

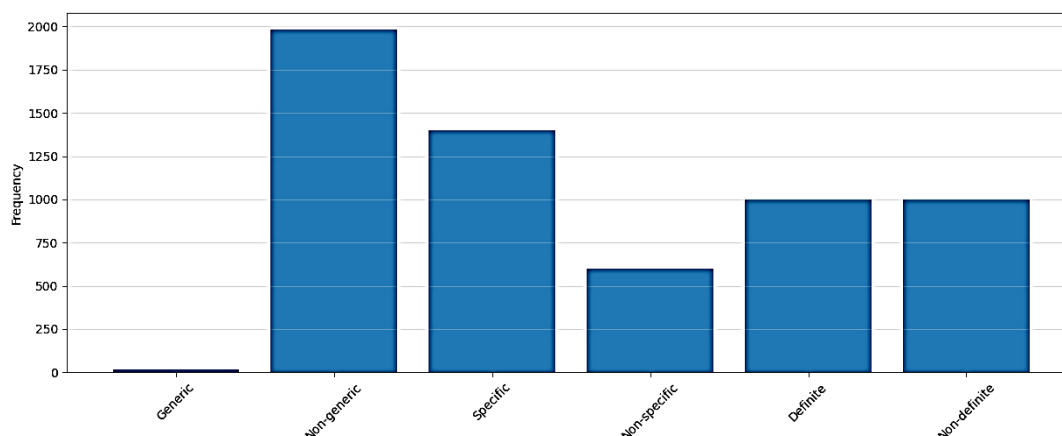
4.3 Semantic Reference Types

The 2,000-item reference-coding dataset shows that economic news strongly favors non-generic reference. There are 1,981 non-generic samples and only 19 generic samples. Specific reference also predominates: 1,402 samples are specific and 598 are non-specific. Because the dataset contains 1,000 definite and 1,000 indefinite article noun phrases, definiteness is evenly balanced by design. This means that the sample structure was controlled, while contextual coding was still able to reveal meaningful patterns in specificity and genericity.

Table 5: Overall Semantic Reference Categories in the RQ2 Dataset

Dimension	Category	Frequency	Percentage
Genericity	Generic	19	0.95%
Genericity	Non-generic	1,981	99.05%
Specificity	Specific	1,402	70.10%
Specificity	Non-specific	598	29.90%
Definiteness	Definite	1,000	50.00%
Definiteness	Non-definite	1,000	50.00%

Figure 4: Overall Semantic Reference Categories in the 2,000-Sample Dataset



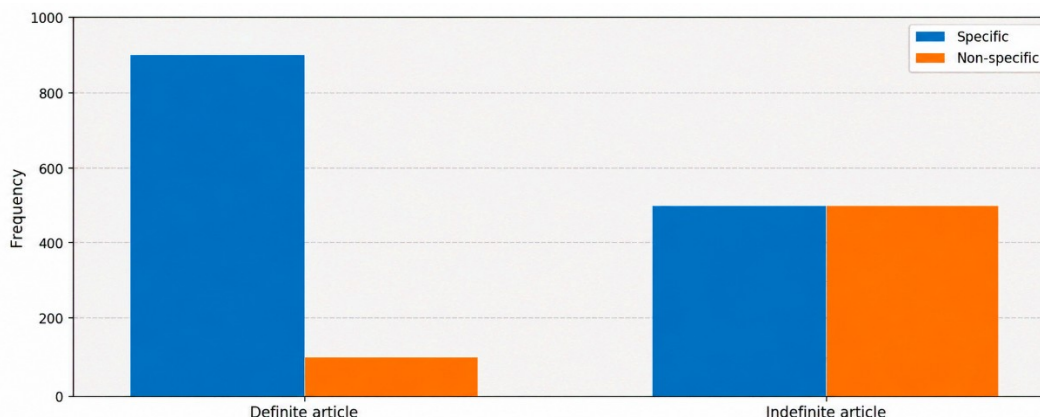
Note. The figure shows the frequency of each semantic reference category in the 2,000-sample RQ2 dataset. These values come from the coding of genericity, specificity, and definiteness. The pattern shows that non-generic and specific references dominate, while generic reference is rare.

Definiteness is structurally linked to article type in this design: definite article samples were coded as definite reference, while indefinite article samples were coded as non-definite reference. The more revealing dimensions are specificity and genericity. Specificity results show that both article types can occur with specific reference, but definite article noun phrases are especially associated with particular institutions, indicators, and event-bound referents. Indefinite article noun phrases are more divided because they often introduce new specific items but also appear in predictive, evaluative, or hypothetical contexts.

Table 6: Specificity by Article Type

Article type	Specific	Non-specific	Specific %	Non-specific %
Definite article	903	97	90.30%	9.70%
Indefinite article	499	501	49.90%	50.10%

Figure 5: Specific and Non-Specific Reference by Article Type



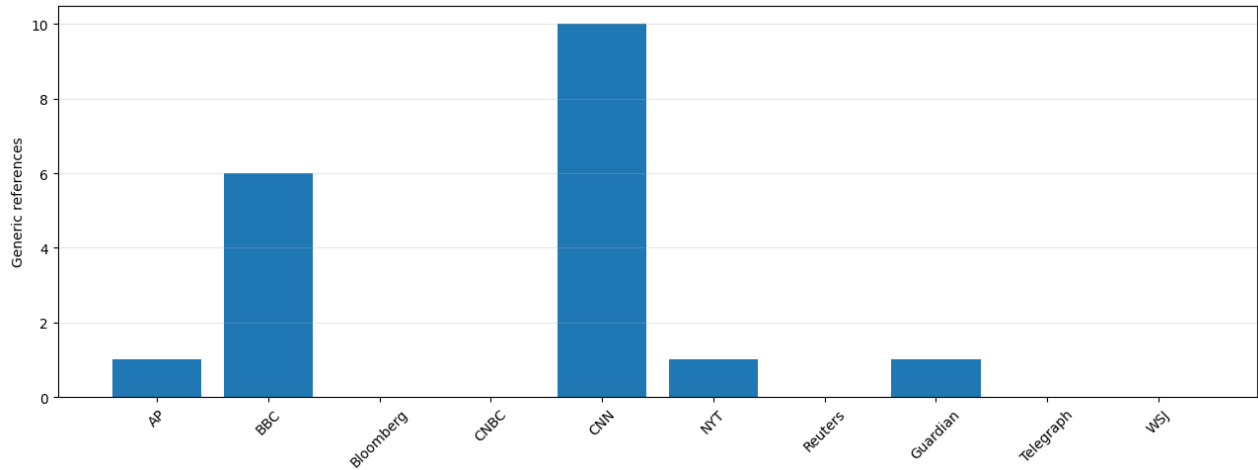
Note. The figure shows how specific and non-specific references are distributed across definite and indefinite article samples. Specific reference means that the noun phrase refers to a particular entity, event, indicator, amount, or context-bound situation. The result shows that definite article samples are mostly specific, while indefinite article samples are divided more evenly between specific and non-specific uses.

Genericity is very low across the dataset. This result suggests that economic news mainly reports particular developments rather than making broad general statements about classes or kinds. Even when nouns such as *economy*, *market*, *government*, or *bank* appear abstract, they are often tied to a specific national, institutional, temporal, or event-based context.

Table 7: Genericity by Article Type

Article type	Generic	Non-generic	Generic %	Non-generic %
Definite article	12	988	1.20%	98.80%
Indefinite article	7	993	0.70%	99.30%

Figure 6: Generic Reference by Outlet in the RQ2 Sample



Note. The figure shows the number of generic references in each outlet. Generic reference means reference to a class, kind, domain, or general concept rather than to a particular event or situation. The low values show that economic news mainly reports specific contexts and developments rather than broad generic statements.

4.4 Outlet-Level Semantic Results

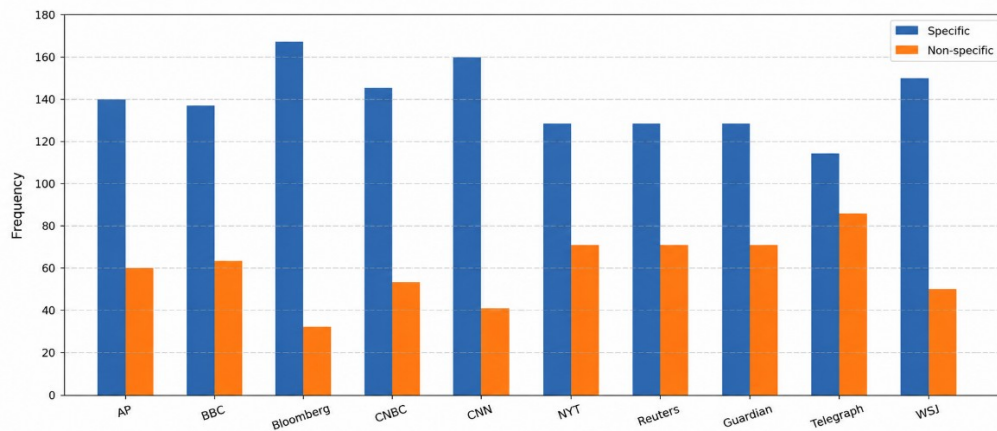
Outlet-level semantic results show variation in specificity while maintaining a shared preference for non-generic reference. Bloomberg has the highest number of specific references, while The Telegraph has the lowest. Generic references remain rare overall, although CNN and BBC record slightly more generic cases than most other outlets. This suggests that outlet style may influence the degree of specificity, but the broader discourse pattern remains stable: economic news is mainly event-oriented and non-generic.

Table 8: Semantic Reference Categories by Outlet

Outlet	Rows	Def. article samples	Indef. article samples	Generic	Non-generic	Specific	Non-specific	Definite ref.	Non-definite ref.
AP	200	100	100	1	199	140	60	100	100
BBC	200	100	100	6	194	137	63	100	100
Bloomberg	200	100	100	0	200	168	32	100	100
CNBC	200	100	100	0	200	147	53	100	100
CNN	200	100	100	10	190	159	41	100	100
NY Times	200	100	100	1	199	129	71	100	100
Reuters	200	100	100	0	200	129	71	100	100

Outlet	Rows	Def. article samples	Indef. article samples	Generic	Non-generic	Specific	Non-specific	Definite ref.	Non-definite ref.
The Guardian	200	100	100	1	199	129	71	100	100
The Telegraph	200	100	100	0	200	114	86	100	100
Wall Street Journal	200	100	100	0	200	150	50	100	100

Figure 7: Specific and Non-Specific Reference by Outlet



Note. The figure shows outlet-level variation in specific and non-specific reference. Specific reference denotes particular entities, events, indicators, institutions, or amounts, whereas non-specific reference denotes hypothetical, abstract, evaluative, or less concrete meanings. Specific reference is dominant in most outlets, although the size of the difference varies.

4.5 Reliability and Statistical Tests

Inter-coder reliability was strong. Pairwise similarity reached 96.50% for Inter-coder 1 versus Inter-coder 2, 95.83% for Inter-coder 1 versus Inter-coder 3, and 96.33% for Inter-coder 2 versus Inter-coder 3. Overall kappa values were high, showing that the coding framework was applied consistently. The strongest agreement appeared in definiteness because article type provided a clear structural cue, while specificity and genericity required more contextual judgment.

Table 9: Pairwise Inter-Coder Similarity and Overall Kappa

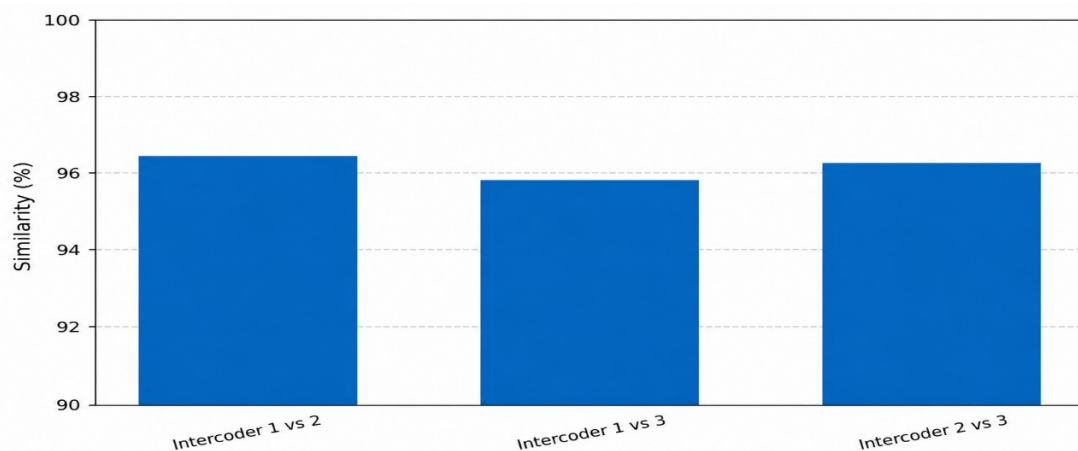
Pair	Same cells	Different cells	Similarity (%)	Overall kappa
Inter-coder 1 vs	579	21	96.50	0.956

Pair	Same cells	Different cells	Similarity (%)	Overall kappa
Intercoder 2				
Intercoder 1 vs Intercoder 3	575	25	95.83	0.947
Intercoder 2 vs Intercoder 3	578	22	96.33	0.954

Table 10: Fleiss' Kappa by Semantic Dimension

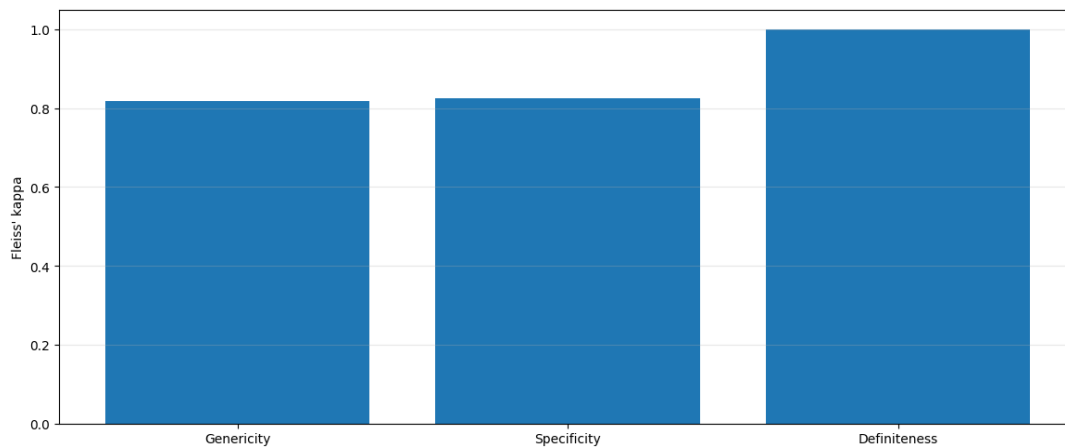
Dimension	Fleiss' kappa	Observed agreement	Expected agreement
Genericity	0.819	0.953	0.743
Specificity	0.825	0.933	0.618
Definiteness	1.00	1.00	0.500

Figure 8: Pairwise Inter-Coder Similarity Across All Coding Cells



Note. The figure shows pairwise similarity between the three anonymized intercoders across 600 coding cells in the reliability subset. Similarity is the percentage of coding decisions that match between two intercoders. The high percentages indicate consistent application of the semantic coding framework.

Figure 9: Inter-Coder Reliability by Semantic Dimension



Note. The figure shows Fleiss' kappa for genericity, specificity, and definiteness. Kappa evaluates observed agreement in relation to the degree of agreement expected by chance. Values above .80 indicate strong reliability, and definiteness achieves full agreement because of its structural alignment with the article-type sampling design.

Chi-square tests confirm significant associations between article type and several semantic coding results. The strongest association appears between article type and definiteness because the sample distinguishes definite and indefinite article forms by design. The specificity and genericity tests are more analytically important because they show how article type interacts with semantic reference rather than simply marking a formal grammatical opposition.

Table 11: Summary of Chi-Square Tests and Effect Sizes

Test	Categories	Chi-square	df	p	Cramer's V	Interpretation
Outlet x article category	the vs a/an	151.21	9	< .001	.042	Significant outlet variation; small effect
Article type x definiteness	definite vs non-definite	1996.00	1	< .001	.999	Perfect alignment in the coded sample
Article type x specificity	specific vs non-specific	387.43	1	< .001	.440	Moderate association
Article type x genericity	generic vs non-generic	0.85	1	.357	.021	No meaningful article-type difference
Outlet x specificity	specific vs non-specific	55.86	9	< .001	.167	Significant outlet

Test	Categories	Chi-square	df	p	Cramer's V	Interpretation
						variation; small-to-moderate effect
Outlet x genericity	generic vs non-generic	54.68	9	< .001	.165	Significant but interpreted cautiously because generic cases are rare

5. Discussion

The findings indicate that the most common overt article form in English economic news is the definite article *the*. This dominance reflects the communicative requirements of the register. Economic journalists frequently refer to institutions, indexes, markets, policies, and public entities that are assumed to be identifiable to the reader. Expressions such as *the economy*, *the market*, *the Federal Reserve*, *the government*, and *the inflation rate* are not merely grammatical noun phrases; they are discourse strategies that present economic entities as identifiable and relevant in the news context.

This result is consistent with definiteness theories that link identifiability and shared knowledge ([Gundel et al., 1993](#); [Hawkins, 1978](#); [Lyons, 1999](#)). In economic reporting, identifiability often comes from institutional knowledge rather than previous mention. Readers of economic news are expected to understand the domain, so a journalist can mention *the market* or *the central bank* without first introducing the referent. This explains why *the* is much more frequent than *a/an* across all ten outlets.

The semantic results also demonstrate the importance of specificity in economic-news discourse. Most sampled noun phrases refer to particular events, institutions, indicators, reports, dates, amounts, or financial situations. This supports the distinction between definiteness and specificity ([Fodor & Sag, 1982](#); [Heim, 1982](#); [von Heusinger, 2002](#)). Although definite noun phrases are strongly associated with specific reference, indefinite noun phrases are not automatically non-specific. Examples such as *a new report* or *an increase* can introduce new but still specific referents.

One of the clearest findings is the very low level of genericity. Only 19 of the 2,000 samples are generic references. This suggests that economic news prioritizes reporting context-bound developments rather than making broad class-level claims. Even apparently general terms often function as non-generic

references when tied to a particular economy, market movement, policy decision, or data release. This finding extends earlier discussions of genericity by showing that professional economic journalism strongly prefers event-based reference over class-level generalization ([Carlson, 1977](#); [Chierchia, 1998](#); [Krifka et al., 1995](#)).

Although outlet variation exists, it does not reverse the overall pattern. Every outlet shows the same broad tendency: *the* is more frequent than *a/an*, specific reference is more frequent than non-specific reference, and non-generic reference dominates. Outlet differences are therefore best interpreted as editorial and stylistic variation within a shared register. Financial outlets such as Bloomberg, Reuters, and The Wall Street Journal may emphasize highly specific market or institutional references, while general news outlets may include somewhat broader explanatory framing.

Methodologically, the study shows the value of combining corpus frequency with semantic coding. Frequency counts alone show that *the* is dominant, but they cannot explain what kinds of reference article forms mark. Semantic coding adds this interpretive layer, and inter-coder reliability supports the consistency of the framework. The balanced corpus design also improves comparability by giving each outlet equal word-level representation. This combined corpus-frequency and semantic-coding approach can be applied to other grammatical features in specialized news discourse.

6. Conclusion

This study examined definite and indefinite articles in English economic news using EENC-2026, a balanced one-million-word corpus compiled from ten selected outlets. The frequency results show that the definite article *the* is much more frequent than the indefinite articles *a/an*. The semantic results show that article-marked noun phrases in economic news are mostly specific and non-generic. These findings indicate that articles play an important role in how economic journalism presents entities, events, institutions, indicators, and developments as identifiable or context-bound. The study contributes to article research by showing how definiteness, specificity, and genericity operate in a specialized professional register. It also supports corpus-based discourse analysis by combining outlet-balanced frequency analysis with a 2,000-item semantic coding dataset and inter-coder reliability checking. The study is limited to overt definite and indefinite articles, ten outlets, and one three-month period. Future research could extend the time span, compare economic news with other registers, or examine related noun-phrase features such as modifiers, possessives, quantifiers, and proper-name reference.

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Appendices

Appendix A: Semantic Coding Framework

The definitions described in the methodology and inter-coder form were used throughout the semantic reference coding framework.

Appendix Table A1: Semantic Coding Framework

Code	Dimension	Reference name	Definition
1	Genericity	Generic reference	Class, kind, domain, or general concept
2	Genericity	Non-generic reference	Particular situation, event, entity, dataset, or context-bound referent
3	Specificity	Specific reference	Particular identifiable entity, event, institution, indicator, or amount
4	Specificity	Non-specific reference	Hypothetical, predictive, abstract, evaluative, general, or not a concrete instance
5	Definiteness	Definite reference	Identifiable, unique, previously mentioned, or contextually known
6	Definiteness	Non-definite reference	Introduced, open, nonspecific, or not uniquely identifiable in context

Appendix B: Sample Coding Table

The format of the semantic coding table is shown in the following extract. The complete RQ2 dataset contains 2,000 coded samples.

Appendix Table B1: Sample Semantic Coding Extract

No.	Outlet	Noun phrase	Article type	Genericity	Specificity	Definiteness	Reason
1	AP	the euro currency union	Definite article	Non-generic	Specific	Definite	A context-bound institutional/economic entity joined by Bulgaria.
2	AP	the European Union's shared currency area	Definite article	Non-generic	Specific	Definite	A uniquely identifiable economic area specified by the phrase.
3	AP	the eurozone	Definite article	Non-generic	Specific	Definite	A named economic region identifiable to readers.
4	AP	the Federal Reserve	Definite article	Non-generic	Specific	Definite	A unique institution in the economic-news context.
5	AP	the economy	Definite article	Non-generic	Specific	Definite	The phrase refers to the economy discussed in the article context.
6	AP	a long-standing national goal	Indefinite article	Non-generic	Specific	Non-definite	A particular goal achieved by Bulgaria is introduced.
7	AP	a common currency	Indefinite article	Non-generic	Specific	Non-definite	A particular currency arrangement in the eurozone context is introduced.
8	AP	a growing economy	Indefinite article	Non-generic	Non-specific	Non-definite	A possible economic condition is discussed rather than a concrete instance.
9	AP	a significant increase	Indefinite article	Non-generic	Specific	Non-definite	A particular reported increase is introduced in the sentence.
10	AP	a potential listing	Indefinite article	Non-generic	Non-specific	Non-definite	The phrase refers to a possible future listing rather than an

No.	Outlet	Noun phrase	Article type	Genericity	Specificity	Definiteness	Reason
							actualized instance.

Appendix C: Inter-Coder Reliability Summary

Appendix Table C1: Pairwise Inter-Coder Similarity

Appendix Table C2: Reliability by Semantic Dimension

Dimension		Fleiss' kappa		Observed agreement		Expected agreement			
Genericity		0.819		0.953		0.743			
Specificity		0.825		0.933		0.618			
Definiteness		1.00		1.00		0.500			
Pair		Same cells		Different cells		Similarity (%)		Overall kappa	
Intercoder 1 vs Intercoder 2		579		21		96.50		0.956	
Intercoder 1 vs Intercoder 3		575		25		95.83		0.947	
Intercoder 2 vs Intercoder 3		578		22		96.33		0.954	

Appendix D: Corpus Frequency Tables

Appendix Table D1: Corpus Frequency Table by Outlet

Outlet	Tokens	<i>the</i>	<i>a</i>	<i>an</i>	<i>a/an</i>	the per million	a/an per million	the share
AP	117,779	5,926	2,129	310	2,439	50,314.57	20,708.28	70.84%
BBC	117,478	6,408	1,880	336	2,216	54,546.38	18,863.11	74.30%
CNN	118,407	5,716	2,351	356	2,707	48,274.17	22,861.82	67.86%
Reuters	118,858	5,624	2,135	312	2,447	47,316.97	20,587.59	69.68%
The Guardian	117,662	6,680	2,272	346	2,618	56,772.79	22,250.17	71.84%
Bloomberg	116,116	6,366	2,262	348	2,610	54,824.49	22,477.52	70.92%
CNBC	119,102	6,100	2,117	325	2,442	51,216.60	20,503.43	71.41%
The Wall Street Journal	116,598	5,991	2,290	391	2,681	51,381.67	22,993.53	69.08%
The New York Times	115,795	6,018	2,405	377	2,782	51,971.16	24,025.22	68.39%
The Telegraph	117,098	6,482	2,073	353	2,426	55,355.34	20,717.69	72.77%

Appendix E: Sample of Sketch Engine Random Sampling Procedure

Screenshots of the Sketch Engine random sampling process used for the second research question are shown in this appendix. The example comes from The Wall Street Journal and displays the 200 concordance lines selected for article-based semantic coding. Only representative pages are shown to document the sampling procedure without reproducing full copyrighted articles.

Appendix Figure E1: Sketch Engine random sample showing the Sample 200 setting and the first concordance lines.



simple a • 2,668

22,882.04 per million tokens • 2.3%



Sample 200 • 200

1,715.3 per million tokens • 0.17%



Details

Left context

KWIC

Right context

1	doc#0 treet Journal.</s><s>The ministry earlier had projected	a	growth of about 4.0% for 2025.</s><s>Manufacturing, v
2	doc#0 ith readers, many of whom are also hunting for work in	a	tough job market, while feeling as though their age cou
3	doc#0 from his sales job at a chemical company in 2023, after	a	decadeslong career in the oil-and-gas industry.</s><s>
4	doc#0 a local wine shop to ask about work, and was hired for	a	seasonal job.</s><s>In 2024, a friend from his oil-indus
5	doc#0 work, and was hired for a seasonal job.</s><s>In 2024,	a	friend from his oil-industry days tipped him off about a p
6	doc#0 virtual career fairs for military spouses—her husband is	a	veteran—and researched companies in advance.</s><s>
7	doc#0 advance.</s><s>If an employer of interest didn't have	a	position that she qualified for, she asked whom else she
8	doc#0 ject-manager role that came up through a connection—	a	remote role helping military veterans find jobs.</s><s>S
9	doc#0 it home proved to be boring.</s><s>She has picked up	a	couple of temporary jobs since then to keep busy, and e
10	doc#0 ers and answering the phone.</s><s>"I just like having	a	job," she said.</s><s>She is currently taking a break to
11	doc#0 ause low-income households just don't have enough of	a	tax liability to offset, notes John Ricco, economic resea
12	doc#0 y Social Security benefits will effectively lose money as	a	result of Medicare Part B premium increases, according
13	doc#0 the contrary: They slowed down price growth.</s><s>	A	separate recent paper by economists at Northwestern U
14	doc#0 bs they have—leaving less room for new workers to get	a	foothold.</s><s>Employment growth slowed markedly
15	doc#0 ase the supply of homes, at a time when the U.S. faces	a	shortage of millions of units nationwide.</s><s>The ad
16	doc#0 move in 2026.</s><s>"Barring an unlikely shock, this is	a	fanciful theory," he said.</s><s>"One does not change
17	doc#0 spects and London and Southern England likely to lag,	a	report from real-estate website Zoopla said.</s><s>The
18	doc#0 n the company's ranking of U.K. property markets, with	an	expected average price rise of 3.4%.</s><s>In England
19	doc#0 South Korea's central bank held its base rate steady for	a	fifth consecutive meeting and removed a reference to p
20	doc#0 rly as April, Citigroup economist Jin-Wook Kim wrote in	a	recent note.</s><s>Monetary policy is shifting toward a
21	doc#0 ing significantly in 2025, hampered by slow growth and	a	rise in business costs.</s><s>Consumers are hesitant
22	doc#0 ita suggests that the economy grew 1.4% over 2025 as	a	whole—a rise in the growth rate compared with a year p
23	doc#0 eholds remain cautious spenders.</s><s>Retail sales,	a	key gauge of consumption, rose 0.9% in December fro
24	doc#0 n costs to consumers.</s><s>Some policymakers see	a	chance that the bank may have to accelerate the pace
25	doc#0 re all but guaranteed," the economist said, now seeing	a	risk that the BOJ might hike before July.</s><s>The Nil

https://app.sketchengine.eu/#concordance?corpname=user%2Fdnabazwarayi%2Fwallstreet_journal_economy&tab=advanced&keyword=a&attrs=wor... 1/7

Appendix Figure E2: Continuation of the Sketch Engine random sample concordance lines.

26	doc#0 <, the popular prime minister said her party was mulling	a	plan to suspend the national sales tax on food and bev
27	doc#0 land grab may come to embody the end of the West as	a	collection of nations united by values.</s><s>In the day
28	doc#0 wn corollary to the Monroe Doctrine, depriving China of	a	key foothold.</s><s>Numerous U.S. presidents have m
29	doc#0 debt will become unsustainable.</s><s>The world has	a	stake in this because Japan is one of the world's larges
30	doc#0 ore to borrow than the U.S., Germany or Switzerland in	a	decade's time, calculates Marcel Kasumovich, senior a
31	doc#0 oding during the pandemic and shrinking somewhat as	a	share of economic output, global public debt is projecte
32	doc#0 ie World Bank's deputy chief economist said.</s><s>In	an	interview, Ayhan Kose said the global economy has sho
33	doc#0 ; have rising populations of young people that will need	a	job over the coming decade.</s><s>"This is a very seri
34	doc#0 European Parliament and the bloc's member countries,	an	EU official said.</s><s>The EU-India deal is set to elim
35	doc#0 Seasonally adjusted unemployment in December fell to	a	joint-record low of 6.2%.</s><s>The eurozone's resilie
36	doc#0 s from Asia's fourth-largest economy jumped 34% from	a	year earlier to \$65.85 billion, following a 13% increase i
37	doc#0 ar-energy sector.</s><s>Back then, he didn't even own	a	car.</s><s>After repeatedly missing the final train back
38	doc#0 person asking the initial question is sometimes offered	a	day off from work.</s><s>Muñoz doesn't speak fluent H
39	doc#0 expected.</s><s>While rate setters believe they are in	a	"good place," there are some clouds on the horizon.</s>
40	doc#0 .</s><s>Another potential source of slowing inflation is	a	surge in imports from China, a threat that drew a lot of
41	doc#0 ng by eurozone banks was directed toward sectors with	a	high reliance on the U.S. market.</s><s>Exporters also
42	doc#0 ed up.</s><s>His comments Thursday might reinforce	a	belief among analysts that the Bank of Canada is set fo
43	doc#0 orking-age Canadians neither employed nor looking for	a	job for a variety of reasons in January, a 2.7% rise on a
44	doc#0 ck, anxiety abounds.</s><s>Many investors are asking	a	fundamental question: What should I do about this?</s>
45	doc#0 olicy rate unchanged as a U.S.-India trade deal eased	a	key economic headwind, for now.</s><s>The Reserve
46	doc#0 ead of research and economist at Elara Capital said in	a	note.</s><s>"A shock to growth-inflation balance woul
47	doc#0 nly propel another rate cut.</s><s>For now, we expect	a	prolonged pause," Kapoor said.</s><s>These Presiden
48	doc#0 yed confidence in his leadership.</s><s>"Bill Miller had	a	terrible time—particularly, his first four or five months—be
49	doc#0 . "quantitative easing," or QE, then days later published	an	op-ed questioning the decision.</s><s>When Warsh w
50	doc#0 it ever does.</s><s>Skeptics say humanoid robots are	a	bubble, and may never find a true use case.</s><s>Ev
51	doc#0 say humanoid robots are a bubble, and may never find	a	true use case.</s><s>Even so, China's momentum is a
52	doc#0 n the likes of Nvidia and Google.</s><s>But China has	a	broad supply chain of manufacturers that make the nut
53	doc#0 4.4%.</s><s>The disconnect between the two reflects	an	unusual environment where, despite the low pace of hir
54	doc#0 restricted the flow of people into the U.S. Coupled with	an	aging country, that has created a situation where there
55	doc#0 unabated.</s><s>Exports rose 69.9% in January from	a	year earlier, official data showed Monday, topping the 5

https://app.sketchengine.eu/#concordance?corpname=user%2Fdnabazwarayi%2Fwallstreet_journal_economy&tab=advanced&keyword=a&atrs=wor... 2/7

Appendix F: Sample Outlet-Level R2 Reference Coding Table

A sample page from the outlet-level R2 reference coding document is provided in this appendix. The example demonstrates how the Wall Street Journal sample records original sentence context, article type, and the three semantic codes used in the analysis.

Appendix Figure F1: Sample page from the Wall Street Journal R2 reference coding table.

Wall Street Journal: R2 Reference Coding

Each row uses the original sentence in context, with the full phrase placed inside brackets.

Summary of Reference Types

Outlet	Rows	Definite Article Samples	Indefinite Article Samples	Generic Reference (Code 1)	Non-generic Reference (Code 2)	Specific Reference (Code 3)	Non-specific Reference (Code 4)	Definite Reference (Code 5)	Non-definite Reference (Code 6)
Wall Street Journal	200	100	100	5	195	148	52	100	100

Reference Coding Table

No.	Full Phrase	Sentences in Context	Article Type	Genericity Code	Specificity Code	Definiteness Code
1	the Ministry of Trade	Gross domestic product expanded 4.8% in 2025, according to advance estimates released Friday by [the Ministry of Trade] and Industry.	Definite Article	2	3	5
2	the median forecast for 4.1% growth	That compared with a 4.4% expansion in 2024 and beat [the median forecast for 4.1% growth] in a survey of five economists by The Wall Street Journal.	Definite Article	2	3	5
3	The Wall Street Journal	That compared with a 4.4% expansion in 2024 and beat the median forecast for 4.1% growth in a survey of five economists by [The Wall Street Journal].	Definite Article	2	3	5
4	The ministry	[The ministry] earlier had projected a growth of about 4.0% for 2025.	Definite Article	2	3	5
5	the 4.3% expansion	Manufacturing, which accounts for a significant share of GDP, grew 7.6% in 2025 from a year earlier, compared with [the 4.3% expansion] in 2024.	Definite Article	2	3	5
6	the economy	While [the economy] held up better than expected, Singapore's growth outlook remains clouded by global uncertainties.	Definite Article	2	3	5
7	The advance estimates	[The advance estimates] also showed Singapore's GDP grew 5.7% in the fourth quarter from a year earlier, compared with 4.3% in the prior quarter.	Definite Article	2	3	5
8	the fourth quarter	The advance estimates also showed Singapore's GDP grew 5.7% in [the fourth quarter] from a year earlier, compared with 4.3% in the	Definite Article	2	3	5

Appendix G: Sample Inter-Coder Reliability Coding Form

Representative pages from the inter-coder reliability coding form are included in this appendix. Three anonymized intercoders used the form to assign one code to each semantic dimension: definiteness, specificity, and genericity.

Appendix Figure G1: Inter-coder reliability form: introductory instructions, consent statement, sample design, and semantic code key.

Inter-Rater Reliability Coding Form

Dear Professor,

You are kindly invited to assist with the reliability checking of a noun-phrase annotation dataset prepared for a research article entitled *Definite and Indefinite Articles in English Economic News: A Corpus-Based Study of Reference Types*. The study is conducted by Nabaz Muhammad Saeed under the supervision of Asst. Prof. Dr. Salih Ibrahim Ahmed.

Your expertise would be greatly appreciated in coding the semantic reference type of selected noun phrases. For each row, enter one numeric code in each of the three coding columns: Genericity, Specificity, and Definiteness.

Your responses will be used solely for the purpose of calculating inter-rater agreement and improving the consistency of the coding framework. Your identity will not appear in the publication or any related report. All responses will be treated as strictly confidential.

Please read the full phrase, article type, and context sentence carefully. Use the semantic code key below. Enter only one code per dimension: Genericity uses 1 or 2, Specificity uses 3 or 4, and Definiteness uses 5 or 6.

Consent

☐ I confirm that I have read the instructions and agree to participate voluntarily. My responses will be used for academic research purposes only.

Sample Design

Category	Count
Total reliability sample	200
Definite article cases	100
Indefinite article cases	100

Coding Instructions and Definitions

Dimension	Semantic Code	Definition and Example
Genericity	1 = Generic / 2 = Non-generic	Generic means the NP refers to a class, kind, domain, or general economic concept. Non-generic means the NP refers to a specific situation, event, dataset, entity, or context-bound referent.

Appendix Figure G2: Inter-coder reliability form: example item and response format for semantic coding.

Specificity	3 = Specific / 4 = Non-specific	Specific means the NP refers to a particular identifiable entity, event, institution, indicator, or amount. Non-specific means the NP is hypothetical, predictive, abstract, evaluative, general, or not a concrete instance.
Definiteness	5 = Definite / 6 = Non-definite	Definite means the referent is identifiable, unique, previously mentioned, or contextually known. Non-definite means the referent is not uniquely identifiable in context.

Example: Do Not Code

Sample ID	Noun Phrase	Full Phrase	Context Sentence	Article Type
EX-001	the euro currency union	the euro currency union	SOFIA, Bulgaria (AP) - Bulgaria has joined the euro currency union on New Year's Day, achieving a long-standing national goal and becoming the 21st member of the European Union's shared currency area.	Definite

Genericity: ☐ Generic ☒ Non-generic
 Specificity: ☒ Specific ☐ Non-specific
 Definiteness: ☒ Definite ☐ Non-definite

Response Format

For each item, enter one numeric code for Genericity, one numeric code for Specificity, and one numeric code for Definiteness.

Coding Table

Sample ID	Full Phrase	Context sentence	Article Type	Genericity Code 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Specificity Code 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Definiteness Code 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-001	the euro currency union	SOFIA, Bulgaria (AP) — Bulgaria has joined the euro currency union on New Year's Day, achieving a long-standing national goal and becoming the 21st member of the European Union's shared currency area.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-002	the European Union's shared currency area	SOFIA, Bulgaria (AP) — Bulgaria has joined the euro currency union on New Year's Day, achieving a long-standing national goal and becoming the 21st member of the European Union's	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite

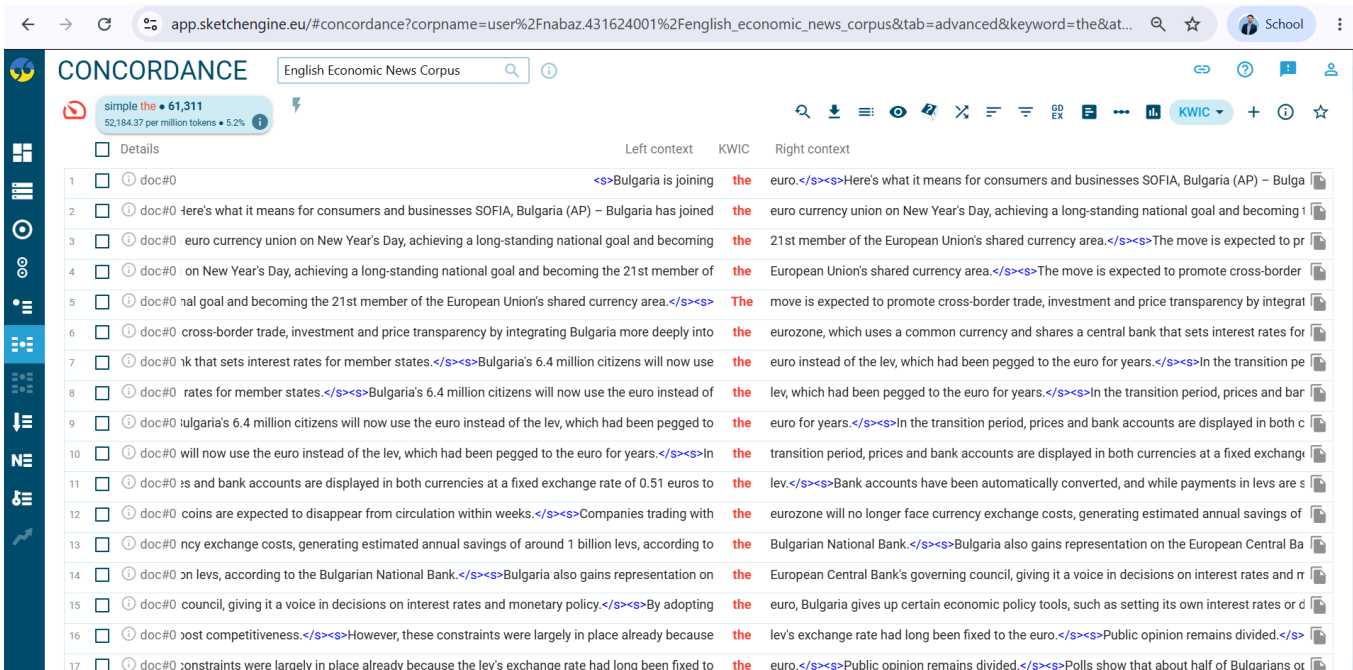
Appendix Figure G3: Inter-coder reliability form: sample coding rows from the 200-item reliability subset.

		shared currency area.		generic	specific	
IRR-003	The move	The move is expected to promote cross-border trade, investment and price transparency by integrating Bulgaria more deeply into the eurozone, which uses a common currency and shares a central bank that sets interest rates for member states.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-004	the eurozone	The move is expected to promote cross-border trade, investment and price transparency by integrating Bulgaria more deeply into the eurozone, which uses a common currency and shares a central bank that sets interest rates for member states.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-005	the lev	Bulgaria's 6.4 million citizens will now use the euro instead of the lev, which had been pegged to the euro for years.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-006	the euro	Bulgaria's 6.4 million citizens will now use the euro instead of the lev, which had been pegged to the euro for years.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-007	the transition period	In the transition period, prices and bank accounts are displayed in both currencies at a fixed exchange rate of 0.51 euros to the lev.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-008	the lev	In the transition period, prices and bank accounts are displayed in both currencies at a fixed exchange rate of 0.51 euros to the lev.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-009	the eurozone	Companies trading with the eurozone will no longer face currency exchange costs, generating estimated annual savings of around 1 billion levs, according to the Bulgarian National Bank.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite
IRR-010	the Bulgarian National Bank	Companies trading with the eurozone will no longer face currency exchange costs, generating estimated annual savings of around 1 billion levs, according to the Bulgarian National Bank.	Definite	Code: ☐ 1 Generic / 2 Non-generic	Code: ☐ 3 Specific / 4 Non-specific	Code: ☐ 5 Definite / 6 Non-definite

Appendix H: Sample Sketch Engine Concordance for Definite-Article Frequency Extraction

This appendix provides a sample of the Sketch Engine concordance used to extract the frequency of the definite article *the* in EENC-2026. The screenshot shows 61,311 hits and 52,184.37 occurrences per million tokens.

Appendix Figure H1: Sketch Engine concordance sample for the definite article *the*



Note. The figure shows the left and right contexts of the keyword-in-context (KWIC) concordance. The full concordance output is not reproduced in order to avoid unnecessary length and copyright-sensitive language reuse.

Appendix I: Sample Sketch Engine Concordance for Indefinite-Article Frequency Extraction

Appendix Figure I1: Sample Sketch Engine Concordance for the Indefinite Article a

The screenshot shows the Sketch Engine Concordance interface. The search query is 'a' in the 'English Economic News Corpus'. The results are displayed in a table with three columns: 'Left context', 'KWIC', and 'Right context'. The results are numbered 1 through 17. The interface includes a search bar, a sidebar with navigation icons, and a top bar with browser tabs and a download history link.

	Left context	KWIC	Right context
1	doc#0 OFIA, Bulgaria (AP) - Bulgaria has joined the euro currency union on New Year's Day, achieving	a	long-standing national goal and becoming the 21st member of the European Union's shared cur
2	doc#0 ment and price transparency by integrating Bulgaria more deeply into the eurozone, which uses	a	common currency and shares a central bank that sets interest rates for member states.
3	doc#0 ntegrating Bulgaria more deeply into the eurozone, which uses a common currency and shares	a	central bank that sets interest rates for member states.
4	doc#0 rs.	a	fixed exchange rate of 0.51 euros to the lev.
5	doc#0 nts have been automatically converted, and while payments in levs are still accepted for about	a	month, change is now given in euros.
6	doc#0 >Bulgaria also gains representation on the European Central Bank's governing council, giving it	a	voice in decisions on interest rates and monetary policy.
7	doc#0 l.	a	small, temporary increase in inflation, typically between 0.2 and 0.4 percentage points.
8	doc#0 wed, inflation stayed elevated and unemployment rose.	a	host of questions for the upcoming year: Will a growing economy eventually boost the sluggish
9	doc#0 nt rose.	a	growing economy eventually boost the sluggish job market?
10	doc#0 ng economy eventually boost the sluggish job market?	a	sign of a stumbling economy that could get worse?
11	doc#0 my eventually boost the sluggish job market?	a	stumbling economy that could get worse?
12	doc#0 nies to step up their production of goods and services without adding more workers, leading to	a	"jobless expansion."
13	doc#0 collection and publication of economic data, leaving policymakers at the Federal Reserve with	a	cloudier view of the economy that will only slowly clear up this year.
14	doc#0 h a cloudier view of the economy that will only slowly clear up this year.	a	time when it is hard to say how 2025 ended," Stephen Stanley, chief U.S. economist at Santand
15	doc#0 ne when it is hard to say how 2025 ended," Stephen Stanley, chief U.S. economist at Santander,	a	investment bank, said in a note to clients.
16	doc#0 n 2025 ended," Stephen Stanley, chief U.S. economist at Santander, an investment bank, said in	a	note to clients.
17	doc#0 e to clients.	a	rising share of spending, so that even healthy growth figures mask underlying weaknesses amc

Note. The figure shows a sample Sketch Engine concordance search for the indefinite article *a* in EENC-2026. The KWIC display presents the left context, keyword, and right context for each item. The final indefinite result in the main analysis combines *a* and *an*.